on 8 November 2016 when he had said, 'There may be some who for some reason are not able to deposit their old 500 or 1,000 rupee notes by 30 December 2016. They can go to specified offices of the Reserve Bank of India up to 31 March 2017 and deposit the notes after submitting a declaration form.'

On 8 November, in the gazette notification through which the demonetization decision was announced, the RBI itself had stated, 'Any person who is unable to exchange or deposit the specified banknotes in their bank accounts on or before 30 December 2016 shall be given an opportunity to do so at specified offices of the Reserve Bank or such other facility until a later date as may be specified by it.'

In contravention of these promises, why was the exchange facility till 31 March 2017 denied to Resident Indians? For NRIs, why were RBI's remaining 26 offices covering other states not opened up? Why was Maharashtra given two locations for this exchange facility, when Kerala, which accounts for 10 per cent of the India's NRI population and 40 per cent of the inward foreign exchange remittances, was given none? There were no answers.

In response to PIL cases filed on this matter, the SC questioned the government's decision to deny people the facilities to exchange their old ₹500 and ₹1,000 notes till 31 March 2017, stating: 'If one can establish that the money was his or hers, you can't deprive them from depositing the money… If there is a genuine person with valid reasons, he should have an opportunity to say that he has failed to deposit his money, and he must be given a window.'

In July 2017, the SC issued notices to the RBI and Finance Ministry on a plea seeking extension for exchange of demonetized notes by siblings Arushi Jain, 22, and Apurv Jain, 25, whose parents had died in a road accident nine years earlier. The siblings were minors when their parents died. The bank lockers were finally opened on the directions of the Succession Court, Saket by an order dated 17 March 2017, two and a half months after the demonetization deadline.